



Grade 1 Social Studies

OPTIMA ACADEMY ONLINE · FAMILY COURSE OVERVIEW · GRADE 1 · FULL YEAR

160 min per week · 2 lessons weekly

About this overview. This document is an example of how the course might be taught. This overview is drawn from the Florida course description and Optima's 2026–27 course plan rather than a fully built course, so scholars may see some variation in sources, activities, and projects from course to course, and between the live school and On-Demand. Each teacher also leans into their own strengths and passions; the structure, expectations, and time commitment below are representative of the course as designed.

In Grade 1 Social Studies, scholars explore what it means to be a thoughtful citizen in their home, school, and community by studying history, geography, civics, and economics through activities that build a foundational understanding of rules, roles, maps, and community helpers. Through stories, pictures, maps, and careful observation, scholars connect past and present, understand community structures and responsibilities, and recognize the roles of people and places in their world. As Florida's course frames it, first graders expand their knowledge of family and community through history, geography, and economics, and learn about their role as a citizen. The seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

THE YEAR AT A GLANCE

1 American History (strand)

Historical inquiry and analysis, historical knowledge, and chronological thinking: using primary sources, comparing life now with life in the past, and ordering events on a timeline.

3 Economics (strand)

Beginning economics: money as a way to exchange goods and services, buyers and sellers, saving for the future, and making choices when resources are scarce.

5 African American History (strand)

Positive influences and contributions by African Americans, woven into the study of the people who shape the nation's story.

2 Geography (strand)

The world in spatial terms: using maps and globes, identifying key map elements and cardinal directions, building a basic map, and describing how location and environment shape community life.

4 Civics (strand)

Foundations of government, civic and political participation, and the structure and functions of government: the purpose of rules and laws, the rights and responsibilities of citizens, and the symbols of the nation and state.

A TYPICAL WEEK

- Two social studies lessons each week.
- The first builds background through stories, pictures, maps, and guided observation.
- The second is applied work such as map activities, sequencing events, role-play, or notebook narration.
- The seven Optima virtues connect to the people and habits scholars study throughout the year.

TIME COMMITMENT

160 minutes / week

two lessons a week, about 80 minutes each

- Each week pairs one background lesson with one applied lesson.
- Project and exhibition weeks may run a little longer.

WHAT SCHOLARS NEED

- A notebook for drawings, narrations, and simple maps.
- Crayons or colored pencils and paper.
- A computer with reliable internet and access to Canvas.
- An adult to support young learners (especially in Kindergarten).

On-Demand (asynchronous). Scholars move through the course at their own pace, with due dates to keep the year on track. An Optima teacher is available throughout for support, feedback, and grading.

Live school. Live-school scholars take this same course on Optima's VR campus with a teacher and classmates, meeting twice a week on the school's weekly schedule.